



CHÂLUS

HAUTE-VIENNE

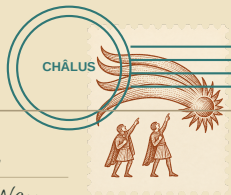
POST CARD

The one with the real paper trail, for once. Châlus, where Richard the Lionheart's whole story ends. He was besieging a tiny castle here over a supposed treasure hoard, of all things, when a crossbow bolt caught him in the shoulder.

The wound turned to gangrene and he was gone within the fortnight. Grim, but it's the kind of ending Rollo's whole line seems to build toward – the fighting, always the fighting. Found an old carving near the gate of a bolt just like the one that got him.

Odd place to start his family's story, at the very end of it, but this is where I began.

With love,
Aunt Liv



TO

John Ericson

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FUN FACT

Richard the Lionheart — Rollo's own descendant, five generations down — died on 6 April 1199, twelve days after a crossbow bolt fired from the castle walls at Châlus-Chabrol struck his shoulder. The wound itself looked minor at first.